

TRANSIT

Yonah's List: All the Transit Expansion in the United States in 2024

A review of 2024 — plus a look at the light rail, metro, and bus rapid transit projects planned to open in 2025.



By Yonah Freemark

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The Streetsblog Photoshop Desk

Across the United States, cities continue to invest in improved and expanded fixed-guideway transit—public transportation investments designed to substantially improve the speed and reliability of bus and rail options.

Nationwide, as I write this, there are under construction 138 kilometers of new light rail or streetcar lines; 34 kilometers of new metro lines; 310 kilometers of new and improved bus lines; and 234 kilometers of regional rail or commuter rail. Many of those projects are expected to open in 2025.

Here, I review the status of transit construction throughout the United States in historical context. I then provide details on what fixed-guideway investments opened in 2024, and which are expected to open in 2025.

This post is based on data compiled on [Transit Explorer](#), the interactive website that assembles information about existing and planned fixed-guideway transit around the world. At the end of this post, find a full list and description of US fixed-guideway transit projects that opened in 2024—plus those planned for opening in 2025. In the coming days, I will publish my *global* roundup of transit openings and planned projects.

The status of transit expansion in the United States

Cities throughout the United States opened very little transit in 2024, adding just 29 kilometers (18 miles) of light rail and no new metro rail service. Though Seattle added some notable new expansions—including an extension north to Lynnwood of its successful light rail route and the first phase of a second line to Bellevue—the only other US light rail expansions were short additions in Los Angeles and Phoenix.



Los Angeles’s new Aviation/Century station, opened in November 2024. Photo: [OrdinaryScarlett](#).



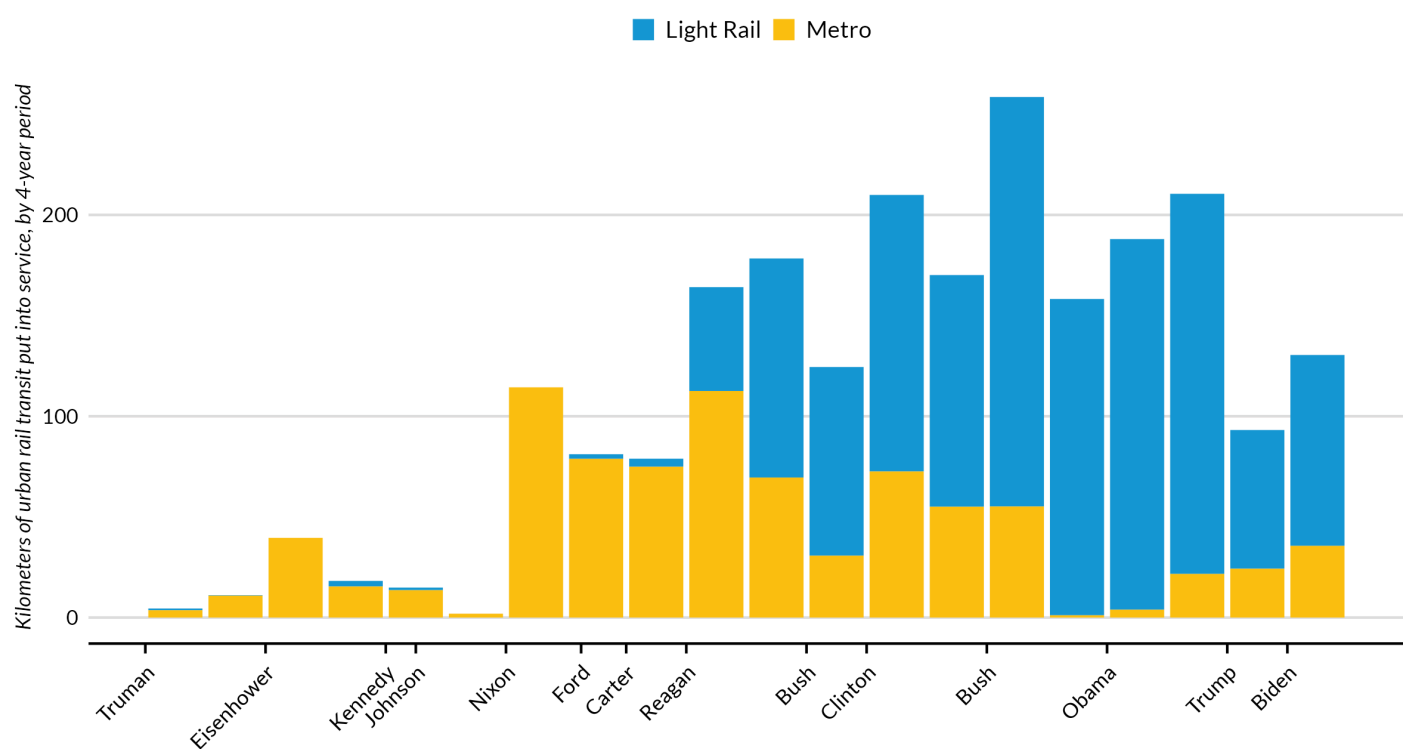
Lynnwood City Center station, north of Seattle, open in 2024, and along the region’s Line 1 light rail line. Photo: [Sound Transit](#).

That slow completion rate reflected a broad shift to other types of investments, with a notably increase in investment in bus rapid transit (BRT) lines, including new corridors that opened in Indianapolis, Madison, and Seattle. The rate of BRT investments will increase in the coming years thanks in part to large investments funded by voter-supported referenda, such as those that passed last November in [Columbus](#) and [Nashville](#).

Despite 2024’s trend, the United States experienced a modest increase in urban rail transit construction over the past four years compared to the previous period, with about 130 kilometers (81 miles) of new metro, light rail, and streetcar lines opening during the Biden Administration, up from fewer than 100 kilometers during the Trump Administration—the lowest level since the 1970s. But transit is still expanding across the country at a far lower rate than it was during the Clinton, Bush, and Obama Administrations (1993–2016). And the opening of new metro lines, in the form of subways and elevateds, has slowed even further from the heights of the 1970s and 1980s.

US urban rail transit openings remain far below peaks of the 1990s and early 2000s

Based on year opened, not year funding approved



Source: Yonah Freemark/The Transport Politic (2025). Note: Light rail includes streetcar service.

In the coming years, the most substantial light rail or streetcar expansion projects are coming to just a few cities. In 2025, Kansas City will more than double the length of its [Main Street streetcar line](#). Los Angeles will add new mileage to its [A Line](#), reaching Pomona; south of LA, Orange County will open

a new streetcar line. In Phoenix, the South Central Corridor will create a branch for the city's light rail route. Finally, in Seattle, the city's Line 2 will extend north to Redmond and west from Bellevue into downtown Seattle. This will substantially increase the length and usefulness of one of the—or even the—most successful light rail system in the nation.



Marymoor Village Station, planned to open in 2025 on Seattle's Line 2 extension to Redmond. Source: [Sound Transit](#).



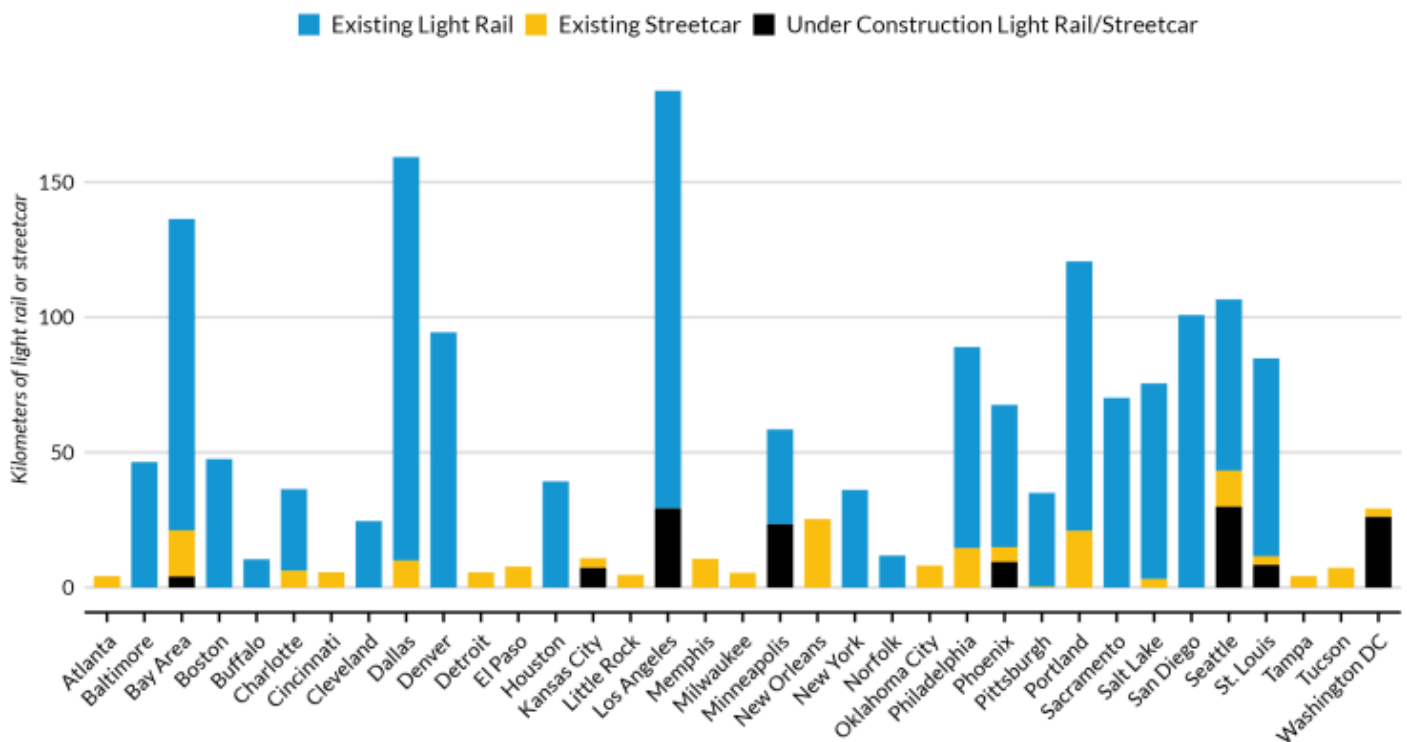
A rendering of a stop on Kansas City's Main Street streetcar extension, planned to open this year. Source: [KC Streetcar](#).

The Purple Line in the Maryland suburbs of Washington, DC is the other large light rail project now under construction, but it's not expected to open for another two years, after a decade of delays.

Across the nation, Los Angeles, Dallas, the Bay Area, and Portland now have the longest light rail networks by far, each with more than 100 kilometers of such lines already in service. They will remain the leaders in the coming decade.

LA, Minneapolis, Seattle, Washington DC's suburbs have longest under construction light rail expansions

All US light rail services, including streetcar and cable cars lines.



Source: Yonah Freemark/The Transport Politic (2025). * Note: Does not include systems in Chattanooga, Dubuque, Fort Collins, Galveston, Johnstown, and Kenosha.

US cities have mostly given up on expanding their metro systems. One exception to this trend is Honolulu, whose Skyline automated light metro opened in 2023 and which is expected to expand past the airport in 2025 (making it more useful than the current line, which doesn't serve major business districts—but the line isn't projected to extend into downtown until 2031). Also in 2025, Los Angeles will extend its D Line (Purple) subway service into the Mid-Wilshire district, the first of three D Line expansions planned in the coming years.



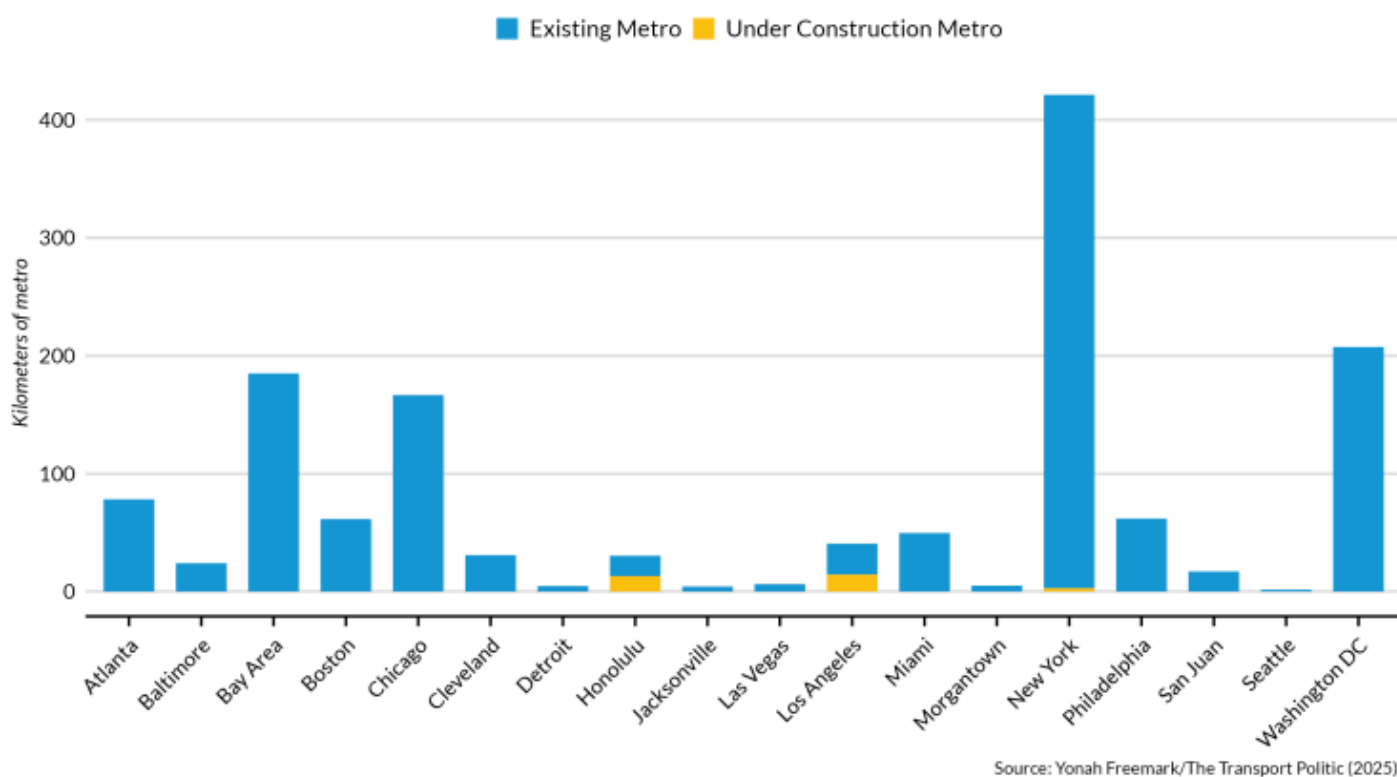
Honolulu's future airport Skyline station (Leleapua), expected to open at the end of 2025. Source: [HART](#).



It is worth noting that there are a few other metro expansion projects in the pipeline, including New York City's [Second Avenue Subway to 125th Street](#) and the [extension of Chicago's Red Line](#) south to 130th Street, which was approved for federal funding in the last few days of 2024 by the lame-duck Biden Administration. A BART extension into downtown San José, on the south side of the Bay Area, is planned. But the other US cities with major metro networks, including Atlanta, Boston, Miami, Philadelphia, and Washington, DC, have no metro expansion projects anywhere close to implementation.

Only Honolulu and Los Angeles have any major metro line expansions under construction in the US

All US metro systems, including monorail and light metro services.



US cities have been far more enthusiastic about investing in bus service. In 2025, [Atlanta](#) and [Austin](#) will each open improved bus routes, in each case funded by voter-approved referenda. And Minneapolis will add its new [B Line](#), an improved bus line with substantial dedicated lanes.

Finally, both Boston and Chicago will extend their commuter rail networks to serve new destinations.

Below, find a full list of all transit expansion projects that opened in the United States in 2024 and that are expected to open in 2025. And consult [Transit](#)

Explorer to explore existing, under construction, and planned transit projects globally.

Projects that opened in 2024

Chicago: Northwest Indiana Double Track Project, 41.5 km (Commuter Rail).

This is not a new line, but the doubling of tracks along the South Shore Line to enable improved service to and from Chicago. This improvement will also enable better service on the West Lake Line, planned to open in 2025 (see below).

Indianapolis: Purple Line, 16 km (Bus Rapid Transit). This is the city's second bus rapid transit line, heading off from the Red Line to the northeast.

Los Angeles: K Line (Crenshaw Line), Phase 2 Aviation/Century, 2.3 km (Light Rail). This is a short extension that is the first phase of a route that will connect with the LAX Airport transit center in 2025.

Madison: Madison Rapid Route A (East-West BRT), 26.7 km (Bus Rapid Transit). This is the city's first rapid transit route, offering 15-minute service on electric buses throughout most of the day. Much of the corridor features bus-only lanes and traffic signal priority. Portions of other lines, Rapid Routes B and F, share station stops.

Miami: Downtown Miami Link, 14.3 km (Commuter Rail). This is a route that finally connects the city's Tri-Rail commuter rail system to downtown; it leverages the new elevated station and tracks built for the Brightline intercity rail service. The service previously terminated at Miami-Dade Airport.

Orlando: SunRail Phase 2 (North), 19 km (Regional Rail). This is an expansion of the city's north-south regional rail line. The extension added one new station at DeLand, north from the previous terminus at DeBary.

Phoenix: Northwest Phase 2, 2.5 km (Light Rail). This extends the city's light rail line to the northwest. The line now terminates at the former site of the MetroCenter Mall.

Seattle: Line 1 (Lynnwood Link), 13.7 km (Light Rail). This route adds several new stations to the north along Seattle's Line 1 light rail service. Eventually, the

line is planned to be extended north to Everett thanks to funding approved by voters in 2016.

Seattle: Line 2 (East Link), South Bellevue–Redmond Technology, 10.1 km (Light Rail). This is the first phase of the Line 2 light rail service; the connection to downtown Seattle will be implemented in 2025 (see below). This segment includes the line through downtown Bellevue, a major suburban business district.

Seattle: RapidRide G (Madison Street), 4.6 km (Bus Rapid Transit). This is a line that runs northeast from downtown, and includes substantial segments of roadway with dedicated lanes for bus service.

Seattle: Swift Orange Line, 17.8 km (Arterial Rapid Transit). This adds a new bus service to Snohomish County, north of Seattle. This is the third Swift Line operated by Community Transit, and it links the city of Mill Creek with the newly opened Lynnwood City Center station on Link Line 1 (see above).

Seattle: Swift Blue Line Extension, 2.6 km (Bus Rapid Transit). This project expands a service operated by Community Transit in Snohomish County south from Aurora Village to connect with the Shoreline North/185th Street station on Link Line 1 (see above).

Projects that are planned for opening in 2025

Atlanta: MARTA Rapid Summerhill line, 5.4 km (Bus Rapid Transit). This new line will make for Atlanta's most substantial new transit investments in decades, funded by the MORE MARTA sales tax referendum voters passed in 2016. It will be the city's first BRT investment. The Rapid Summerhill line will run on mostly dedicated lanes south from downtown along Hank Aaron Drive to the Beltline.

Atlanta: Cleveland Avenue and Metropolitan Parkway lines, 15.1 km total (Arterial Rapid Transit). Also funded by MORE MARTA, these are more modest improvements than the Summerhill BRT project, both featuring more frequent service and improved bus stops compared to existing service. The Cleveland Avenue line will run east-west, connecting to the East Point MARTA rail station. The Metropolitan Parkway line will run north-south, connecting to the West End MARTA rail station.

Austin: Expo Center and Pleasant Valley lines, 42.9 km total (Arterial Rapid Transit). These two improved bus routes are the first major investments to come after Austin voters passed Project Connect, a referendum funding transit, in 2020. The Expo Center line (Rapid 837) will run from Republic Square northeast to the city's Expo Center; the Pleasant Valley Line (Rapid 800) will run north-south from the Mueller neighborhood to Easton Park. Though services will be implemented in 2025, final improvements are planned for 2026.

SF Bay Area: SMART Train Phase 2 to Windsor, 4.9 km (Regional Rail). This one-station extension will add a northerly terminus for the Sonoma-Marín Area Rail Transit (SMART) line, which opened for service in 2017.

Boston: South Coast Rail Phase 1, 60.4 km (Commuter Rail). This project will extend the MBTA's commuter rail network with new service to Fall River and New Bedford, both south of Boston. The phase of the project opening in 2025 will use Middleborough Line tracks to reach Boston. A second phase, which would provide a faster service to Boston via Stoughton, has yet to be funded.

Chicago: West Lake Corridor, 12.8 km (Commuter Rail). This project will extend the South Shore Line through Lake County, Indiana, creating a new service from Munster and Hammond to Chicago's Millennium Station.

Honolulu: Skyline Aloha Stadium–Middle Street, 8.1 km (Metro). This project will extend Honolulu's automated Skyline light metro, whose first phase opened in 2023 from Kualaka'i (East Kapolei) to Halawa (Aloha Stadium). The extension will service Pearl Harbor Navy base and the city's airport before terminating at Middle Street, west of downtown. The extension of the line into downtown, also under construction, is not expected to open until 2031.



Under construction: Phoenix's South Central light rail project, connecting downtown with South Phoenix. Source: [Valley Metro](#).



A rendering of the MARTA Rapid Summerhill BRT project in Atlanta. Source: [MARTA](#).

Kansas City: Main Street Streetcar Extension to UMO-KC, 5.7 km (Streetcar). This project will extend the city's existing streetcar line (which opened in 2016) from Union Station to the University of Missouri at Kansas City. The project is funded by a special tax district and a federal grant. The existing line is already one of the most well-used streetcar lines in the United States.

Los Angeles: D Line (Purple) Extension Phase 1, 6 km (Metro). This project will extend Los Angeles' subway for the first time since 1996, adding three new stations to the west, from Wilshire and Western Avenues to Wilshire and La Cienega Avenues. Additional extensions to Century City and the city's VA Hospital are expected to open in 2026 and 2027, respectively. Eventually, the D Line is expected to be the city's most-used transit line, as it serves the densely populated west side of the city.

Los Angeles: A Line (Gold Line Phase 2B to Pomona), 14.9 km (Light Rail). This project will extend the A Line from suburban Azusa to Pomona, to the east. With service as far south to Long Beach, the A Line is already the longest light rail line in the world; with the Pomona extension, it will reach 93 kilometers. By 2030, the line is to be extended further east, to Montclair in San Bernardino County.

Los Angeles: K Line (Crenshaw Line), Phase 3 LAX/Metro Transit Center, 1.6 km (Light Rail). This extension will connect both ends of the K Line, allowing through service from the Expo/Crenshaw station to Redondo Beach, via LAX Airport. An automated people mover linking the LAX Station with the airport is planned to open in 2026.

Los Angeles: OC Streetcar, 7.7 km (Streetcar). This project will serve the Orange County cities of Santa Ana and Garden Grove. The line partially follows the route of the Pacific Electric railway's Santa Ana Line, which ended service in 1950. As a result, unlike many other streetcar lines in the United States (which share space with cars), the project includes substantial sections with dedicated right-of-way.



Rendering of Pomona's future A Line station, east of Los Angeles. Source: [Foothill Gold Line](#).



Miami's South Dade Transitway project will feature major stations. Source: [Miami-Dade Transit](#).

Miami: South Dade TransitWay Corridor, 31.2 km (Bus Rapid Transit). This line will extend south from the Metrorail terminal at Dadeland South into the southern portions of the county. The line opened for service in 1997, but with this project, Miami-Dade County is substantially improving the system's speed, comfort, and reliability through improved stations, fare gates, all-door boarding, and signal preemption.

Phoenix: South Central Corridor, 9.4 km (Light Rail). This project will create a new light rail branch, connected to the city's existing route, along a north-south link on Central Avenue. It will link downtown with South Phoenix.

Seattle: Line 2 (East Link), South Bellevue–Stadium, 12 km (Light Rail). This project will connect Bellevue and downtown Seattle via a bridge over Lake Washington. The project is expected to substantially increase overall Seattle light rail ridership, which now averages more than 100,000 riders a day on Line 1 alone. Line 2 is expected to carry 50,000 riders daily.

Seattle: Line 2 (Downtown Redmond Link Extension), 5.4 km (Light Rail). This is a further extension of Line 2, whose first segment opened last year. Passengers will be able to ride directly from downtown Redmond to Seattle and then north to Lynnwood.

Twin Cities: Gold Line (formerly known as Gateway Corridor), 18.2 km (Bus Rapid Transit). This will be Minnesota's first BRT project that operates primarily in dedicated bus lanes (unlike the B Line, for example; see below). The route will extend east from downtown St. Paul to Maplewood and Woodbury, serving the headquarters of 3M. In 2027, the route will be extended to downtown Minneapolis via lanes on I-94.

Twin Cities: B Line, 18.8 km (Arterial/Bus Rapid Transit). This east-west corridor will connect Uptown Minneapolis with downtown St. Paul, along Lake Street, Marshall Avenue, and Selby Avenue. The project will include dedicated bus lanes along much of the corridor, as well as improved (but fewer) stations compared to the existing bus line, and thus faster service, plus reduced headways between buses.

Note: Dallas's Silver Line, a regional rail link connecting north Dallas County and DFW Airport, may open in 2025 or 2026; as a result of this uncertainty, I have not listed it above. It is of course worth noting that all infrastructure projects may face delays in opening.

Update Jan. 7: The first version of this post incorrectly noted that the B Line in the Twin Cities will not have dedicated bus lanes. In fact it will, along much of its route!



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